

CUSTOMER STORY

Xero: Delivering communications and collaboration at scale with Google Workspace including Google Meet hardware

Xero is committed to collaboration and communication across the business, with the support of solutions like Google Workspace and Meet hardware, where team members can edit documents at the same time and tap into video conference-equipped meeting rooms at offices across the business.



Hi there 🙋 What brings you to Google Workspace today?





Born in the cloud, Xero is a beautiful, easy-to-use platform for small businesses and their advisors around the world. Xero provides its 2+ million subscribers with connections to a thriving ecosystem of 800+ third-party apps and 200+ connections to banks and financial service providers. Founded in 2006 in New Zealand, Xero is now one of the fastest-growing software as a service companies in the world and is a leader in the New Zealand, Australian, and United Kingdom cloud accounting markets.

 New Zealand

[Docs](#)[Drive](#)[Calendar](#)[Google Meet hardware](#)

Google Workspace Results

- Improves internal perception of skills and service delivery of IT team
- Gains ability to collaborate in real time across multiple countries
- Helps enable workplace flexibility across the organization

Increases number of video conference-enabled rooms from 10–12 to 200

A proud New Zealand success story, [Xero](#) is a beautiful platform for small businesses and their advisors around the world.



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expanded, it began investigating products that would meet its longer-term needs.

Garrett Cox, Client Support Team Lead, Xero says, "As our business grew, we looked to deploy a technology stack that would meet our requirements.

"This meant finding software that allowed our people to collaborate and be productive across all the regions we were operating in.

"Our goal has always been to provide technology that just works. We've got stuff to do, so we want our technology to enable us, not get in the way."

Alignment between Google and Xero

Xero began transitioning its workforce across to Google Workspace and saw adoption accelerate organically as people embraced its collaboration features. "Teams at Xero love the ease of use of Google Workspace and how seamlessly all the applications work—for example, how [Docs](#) enables multiple people to jump in and out of documents at the same time to edit and update," says Dan Bowden, Client Support Team Lead, Xero.

"With all staff provided with a Google account, the inclusion of useful apps such as [Drive](#) and the cross-functionality of all its apps has meant that for many of our staff, Google Workspace can be a one-stop shop for their business needs."

Xero founder, Rod Drury, says, "Employees found it so liberating to move their work from 'my own laptop' into the secure Google Cloud. Everyone just feels freer because they can work wherever they want, on any device, and not worry about losing documents."

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Easy to pick up the skills

can become an expert in Google Workspace in a short time without any training,” says Bowden.

A new video conferencing system

As Xero grew, the team knew they needed to find a new video conferencing system. The business had 10 or 12 units operating globally—one or two per office—that required significant investment to keep running.

Xero staff who booked rooms for video meetings had to work with third-party managed conference bridges on which it was difficult to share content and collaborate. “We were experiencing inefficiencies such as paying to keep third-party support team members on hand during global meetings involving multiple participants—to ensure they could fix issues that arose during these calls,” says Bowden.

“Use of Google Meet hardware is through the roof. Our workers are embracing the ability to walk into a room, connect quickly and easily to a meeting, and enjoy responsive, professional support. We spend less time supporting these 200 meeting rooms than the 10 or 12 we had with our previous video conferencing equipment.”
—Dan Bowden, Client Support Team Lead, Xero

Other issues included a lack of integration between the calendar product being used at the business and the meeting software—forcing staff to locate links to video calls provided in messages separate to meeting calendar invitations.

Seamless integration



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with apps such as [Calendar](#). “We conducted a proof of concept and installed Google Meet hardware in one or two in each of our offices around the world,” says Bowden.

“Based on the hugely successful outcome of the trial, we went all in and installed Google Meet hardware in every single meeting room we had—close to 200 rooms globally.”

Google Meet hardware is now one of the most frequently used products within the business and the number of meetings compromised by technical incidents has fallen. “Use of Google Meet hardware is through the roof,” says Bowden. “Our people are embracing the ability to walk into a room, connect quickly and easily to a meeting, and enjoy responsive, professional support. We spend less time supporting these 200 meeting rooms than the 10 or 12 we had with our previous video conferencing equipment.”

Utilization levels have climbed to a level that the business is now looking to extend the deployment of Google Meet hardware to about 50 small phone rooms and potentially freestanding booths within its offices worldwide.

Bowden, who manages a team distributed across Australia, Canada, the United Kingdom, and the United States, describes the experience of using Google Workspace as “incredible.”

“Seeing updates instantly while I’m on video calls, using Sheets and Docs and generally collaborating with people in different countries is a brilliant experience,” he says.

Xero has also integrated Calendar with its internal meetings app so that all meetings appear in both apps.

can now record and livestream video meetings —as well as provide the support ourselves.” — Garrett Cox, Client Support Team Lead, Xero



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in their roles, collaborate, and communicate effectively. “Thanks to Google Workspace, including Google Meet hardware, we can now record and livestream video meetings—as well as provide the support ourselves,” says Cox. “There is very little we have to do.”

helping us pave the way for more effective collaboration and communication—and ultimately a more connected business.” — Garrett Cox, Client Support Team Lead, Xero

Bowden says “What’s impactful with Google Workspace is its ability to record a version of a meeting that can be shared with people who can’t attend or want to revisit it later,” he says. “People can join halfway through the meeting if they want and either watch it from that point or from the start. We also can invite someone remotely to share slides and present. Just recently, we’ve also started allowing people to share prerecorded, high-definition video content.”

Since moving to Google Workspace, the internal perception of the Xero technology team has also improved. However, with better experience comes higher user expectations, which Cox and Bowden say the team welcomes.

“We have confidence in our ability to deliver a consistent, reliable, scalable service with Google Workspace and Google Meet hardware. “Google Workspace is helping us pave the way for more effective collaboration and communication—and ultimately a more connected business,” concludes Cox.



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